

Chapter 1: The Nothing

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Before the Realms...

Before Mana...

Before Ardron...

There was only the Void, and what resided within it.

It has no beginning, no end, and no known purpose. Yet, somehow, it exists.
And within it... there we were.

Six Voidlings, drifting across the endless expanse.

We weren't always together.

We found each other through drifting and through time. And once you find another in the Void? It is best to keep an eye on them.

Zykius once had another companion, another Voidling he had found while drifting. But one day, Zykius fell asleep while watching over him, and they drifted apart into parts unknown, never to find each other again.

That was over 160 years ago. Time is meaningless when all you can do is coast along the great nothing.

Nothing new to see. Nothing new to experience... except my friends.

They give me a reason to keep going. A purpose. Something to study, something to watch, even if only to protect them and ensure we never lose each other.

My friends... I will drift with you every day.

Together.

Chapter 2: The Experiment

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Another unrecognizable day in the Void, as we all perform the mundane task of... existing.

While the others are being rowdy, Zykius and I begin discussing what exactly we are. We have to be... something. We're alive. We have consciousness. We can see each other, although our forms aren't defined. We simply... are.

Zykius and I were always closer to each other than we were to the other four. While Iwata was curious, it was more out of whimsy and fascination than any desire to simply understand the concept.

One day, we began testing what we were. Testing our limits.

We discovered that we were, at the very least, solid. Not incorporeal. We could interact with each other's features and, for lack of a better term, "bodies."

We shared our discoveries with the others, but they didn't seem to care, save for Astus. He didn't want to experiment, though. He simply wanted to mentally log our findings.

While watching Iwata and Sythys playing, we noticed an... "incident." Iwata became stuck inside Sythys for a very brief moment.

Zykius and I immediately turned to each other.

"Did you see that?! How!?"

Without another word, we began testing. We were solid... but not completely.

He first tried "punching" me (as much as a blob can punch, I suppose), but to no avail.

That's when I suggested he have Astus hold him and brace him while I charged directly at him with all the speed I could gather.

I slipped inside him... and my eyes were opened to the possibility of everything.

But more importantly...

I saw a purpose.

While inside Zykius' soul... I could see the entire universe. I could see the truth, and I could see power. I honed in on it... I now had a goal. No more aimless drifting.

It took the combined power of Tynos and Astus to remove me from inside Zykius, but once they did, they asked if I was alright.

I didn't answer. Instead, I asked if Zykius was alright. He was my best friend, and after what I had just done to him? He mattered more.

I think his answer surprised all of us.

He stated that he was alright, but that he... was me.

I had no idea what he was talking about, nor did the others. They all looked at me, then at him, then back at me again with stupid looks on their forms.

So, I pressed again, asking him if he was alright. He said that he was if I was. I told him that was a very stupid way to phrase it, and bonked him.

I then asked him what he saw, or what it felt like. His description was maddeningly unhelpful. He described it as "very full," because what else would it feel like, I guess.

Zykius asked me what I saw or felt. I told him it was indescribable, but the good news was... I now knew where to go.

The others looked at me as if I had lost my mind, which is fair, considering I had just lost my body for a moment, so I can't blame them. So, I explained more.

I told them there was this... source of energy, in that direction (as I pointed), and that we should go towards it.

Tynos, being Tynos, said it was unwise and possibly unsafe.

I told him that he was boring, and what else were we going to do?

He didn't have an answer for that.

Iwata was finally happy to go on an adventure. Sythys was going to follow Iwata regardless of where she went.

Astus wanted to survey the Void, so he was up for it.

Zykius said he was intrigued, considering he got this information from inside himself. So, he wanted answers now.

Afterwards, we all rallied against Tynos to follow us because we were all going regardless, and if he wanted to stay behind? That was up to him.

That grump, of course, decided to go with us, begrudgingly.

Chapter 3: The Journey

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So I was a little shaken up after "the incident," as we're calling it. Though I think Entar refers to it more as an experiment.

Either way, I feel my core is... weakened? Stressed? Exhausted?

Something new I've never felt before, for sure.

All the while we traveled, Tynos was being his usual grumbly self. Until he acted out and yelled at us that we were just wasting time.

Wasting time? Brother, that's all we do is waste time. We have nothing to do. So I asked him what the hell he would rather spend his time doing. Counting the particles of the Void mist, or triangulating the direction light rays are coming from?

He just stopped facing me and acted all huffy, with no answer.

Iwata dragged him by his end as we kept floating towards this seemingly impossibly far endpoint which only Entar knew of.

Like originally stated, what the hell else were we going to do?

Although actually doing all this intentional moving was more exhausting than just listlessly drifting everywhere.

Maybe that's why Tynos was so grumpy. The extra watch duty, but that doesn't seem like him.

That seems right up his alley, what with the proper order and whatnot.

He took every shift he could. He always seemed to have boundless energy. Similar to Iwata.

With that speculation, I truly have no idea what was getting on his nerves.

Maybe it was because it was Entar's plan to do this, and he wasn't exactly Entar's biggest fan due to the way Entar did things. Bypassing limits, safety, and order.

I get it, but that's sort of silly to get hung up on constantly.

Entar is just a little eccentric for research, the way Iwata is just... eccentric.

While on our journey, we passed another Voidling, but it was... different.

It was speaking straight-up nonsense. Not in the way of saying crazy things; I mean more akin to speaking gibberish, but with intent.

It was frightening, to say the least.

We just let them go back to their ramblings... and kept on our goal.

Journey Date: Awakening 819.

According to my logs, I have awakened eight hundred and nineteen times since we started this journey.

Tynos is in disarray the closer we get to our goal.

Zykius and Entar are giddy with excitement.

Iwata is wearing on Sythys' nerves, constantly asking, "Are we there yet?"

I have simply recorded everything I deemed of import.

The most notable being that of the strange Voidling we found...

While the others were keeping their distance... I tried what Entar did to Zykius 819 awakenings ago.

I learned of this... creature. It had a bulbous head... and what looked like long ends attached to its face?

I peered into this Voidling's memory... It gave me an incredible headache, so I quit and retracted from the poor creature.

I realized it had gone insane from whatever this creature was. It intrigued me to no end.

A creature such as that lives somewhere in the Void. Something that is... not of our kind, but of a much higher intelligence and power.

This frightens me. Is this where Entar is leading us? To one of these creatures? Just to be driven insane?

I won't understate my curiosity, but I have an idea to limit my exposure.

I must prepare for the worst of Entar's destination, but I must also consider... Why would even Entar be afraid of the rogue Voidling if he saw those creatures while inside Zykius? It simply does not add up.

As such, I have to believe Entar is not leading us to those creatures, but to something even more unknown.

The possibilities excite and terrify me...

I have no recourse but to keep following Entar as he glides with intention. A straight, aimed line. No guessing and no doubts.

We've been gliding for so long, I've almost forgotten why.

Of course, Entar keeps reminding us that we're almost there, and with the way he travels with such conviction, I have no reason not to believe him.

Another awakening goes by. We are all exhausted... except Entar.

He has this... look in his eyes. It's not frightening. It's inspiring.

That's when we all feel it. It was truly indescribable.

Imagine your body being filled with contentedness. No worries, problems, or issues.

All exhaustion left us the second we were within its range.

Iwata perked up and started rocketing towards the source.

Entar quickly followed suit behind her. They had a little race.

I probably would've been terrified of losing them if we all weren't following after them, trying to keep up.

Sort of difficult to take care of others when you can't even reach them.

We quickly noticed... the closer we got to the source, the more powerful we became. As such, the more quickly we moved as well.

We didn't sleep. We didn't need to anymore. We just kept moving. I don't know how long the journey took once we were within the power's range. Time seemed to have disappeared entirely.

I'm sure sooner than we expected... we found the source of power.

Entar exclaimed that it was precisely the same as what he saw inside Zykius that awakening.

Tynos piped up, asking why Entar didn't just tell us what it was.

Entar asked if we would even believe him, and how could he explain... this?

After taking a long look at... the thing, I had to side with Entar. I don't even know how to explain the creature I was staring at, and even though it wasn't looking at us... I felt it staring back at us too.

Tynos and Entar bickered for a bit. I attempted to break them up, to no avail.

What a fool I was... While I was busy taking care of those two... Iwata approached the creature... and started talking to it.

Chapter 4: The Primordial

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So like, what we saw before us seemed to be some sort of swirling creature filled with... lightning, plasma, clouds, light, dark, plants, dirt, and many other things.

So I did what any normal person would do.

I glided up to it and said hi.

It turned to face me and just stared at me for a hot minute. Rude.

It then raised its hand and... headpatted me? Then it raised its other hand, and it felt like the entire universe lurched forward towards the creature.

That's about the time I noticed the others were right next to me.

The creature then spread its hand, and suddenly we were all in a circle surrounding it.

It then headpatted the others. I thought we were playing a game. So I headpatted Sythys, because why not?

She shot me a look of "not the time to play," but the creature was playing, so why couldn't I?

The creature must have noticed this because it grabbed Sythys' face and made her face the creature. Sythys was scared half to death.

Then the creature turned and looked at me.

I just waved my end at it. The creature tilted its head.

So I gave it a headpat. It gave me one. That's fair, right?

It leaned closer to my face, which again? Rude. Personal space, please.

...I can't even explain what happened next?

It first grabbed Sythys. Not in a harmful way... more like containing her?

It then decided, for some reason, that my chest is where its wrist should live.

I felt myself filling up... with its power. It felt very hot. Uncomfortably hot, but also fast. I knew Entar would never beat me in a race again, for sure.

It felt like this went on for an eternity. The best way I can describe it is? It's as if my entire DNA was being rewritten.

It removed its... ARM? from my chest.

Well, I guess it's better to say its arm dissolved into my chest? And it pulled away once its arm was gone? As if it gave a piece of itself to me.

Everyone else looked stunned, just staring at me.

I said, "What?"

They said I looked beautiful... and frightening.

This is when I noticed I was no longer a Voidling.

I had a body, similar to the creature's, but it was more solid than theirs was.

Before I had time to figure out what even was going on, it turned its attention to Sythys and began squeezing the life out of her.

Least that's what we thought it was doing.

Instead, these tendrils? Roots? Something came out of its hand and went into Sythys, and same as before, its arm disappeared... and Sythys had a new body, same as I did.

Zykius and Entar looked at each other and formed a line.

The creature raised its new hand and spread it again, forcing them back into circle formation.

It looked at Entar and Astus and shoved its new arms into both of them at once.

When the creature pulled away... Entar and Astus had bodies, and the creature's new arms were gone... but they didn't come back.

It turned its head towards Tynos and shoved its left foot into him... and Tynos now had a new body like the others.

But Zykius? Zykius got a different treatment.

Zykius stared at the creature, wincing, awaiting everything. But the creature looked at Zykius very carefully for a second, tilted its head, and then dived completely into Zykius.

The creature just... committed suicide? Giving us its power?

I don't understand why.

Entar stared at Zykius and asked if he was okay, and wondered how he felt, as he had just had this strange creature not just break a limb off into him, but a leg, torso, and head... and the rest of it went into Zykius.

Zykius said he had never felt better, and that he finally felt "whole." Whatever that means.

...Then we started figuring out what happened.